



Complete Brand Guidelines

Edition 01 · August 2026

We make companies wanted.
Growth is what happens next.

Wanted, on purpose.

Everything needed to make, print, publish and ship Not by Accident correctly.
Rules are short. Where a rule is absent, use judgement and the House pair.

01

Essence

Who we are, in one page.

We make companies wanted. Growth is what happens next.

Not by Accident is an independent creative company working across brand strategy, identity, creative direction, product, digital experience, growth, campaigns, technology and culture.

Brand thinking and commercial thinking are not separated into different rooms.

The offer

POSITION — where the company stands and why anyone should care.

IDENTITY — how it looks, sounds and behaves.

PRODUCT — where people meet it and decide.

DEMAND — how it gets wanted at scale.

Wanted, on purpose.

Five principles

Specific

Name the material, the month, the number, the street. "A range of" is not a description.

Decided

Present decisions as decisions. Two routes, never three. The recommendation comes first, not last.

Warm, not soft

People, hands, imperfection and humour. The identity itself stays sharp.

Culturally awake

References from outside design. Credited, always, and never explained.

Quietly funny

One human moment per communication. In the last line, never the headline.

Premium here comes from judgement, editing, typography, material, proportion and specificity. Not from beige, black or minimalism.

02

Recognition

Six codes. The brand survives when the logo is absent.

How we are recognised

01 Symbol

The Nick. One shape, one colour, no gradient. It carries the brand alone at 16px and at three metres, and it is the only element that can travel with no name attached.

02 Wordmark

A low-contrast printed serif with weight in unexpected places. Recognisable set small in a footer, without the symbol beside it.

03 Colour relationships

Milk with Beetroot, interrupted by Pickle or Yolk. Colour is recognised as a relationship and a proportion, never as a single swatch.

04 Typography

A display serif against a plain grotesk, with one expressive face used almost never. The contrast between the two is the signature.

05 Photography

Selection, not treatment. Three registers, honestly matched to the situation, with no filter and no house grade.

06 Composition

Small type against large empty areas, dense pages allowed to be dense, and colour arriving at an edge rather than as a field.

Together they are unmistakable. Independently, any two of the six are enough.

03

Identity

Symbol, wordmark, lockups, and how to use them.

SYMBOL

The Nick



Use alone

Favicons, avatars, embroidery, stamps, packaging, signage, film end cards, merchandise.

Construction

A single closed path. Eight points. One chamfered corner, one wedge cut into the right edge.

Reproduction

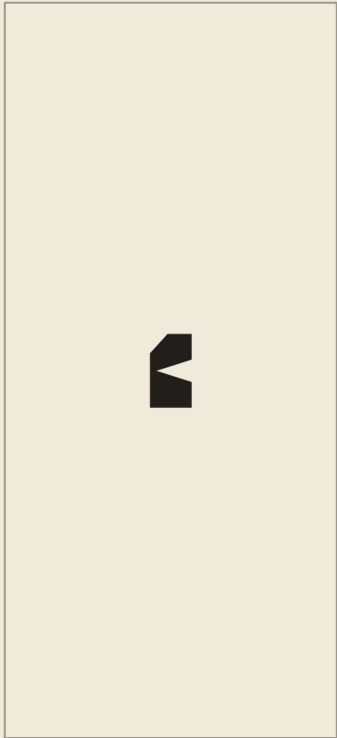
Always from supplied vector. Never redrawn, never rebuilt from a description, never traced.

Colour

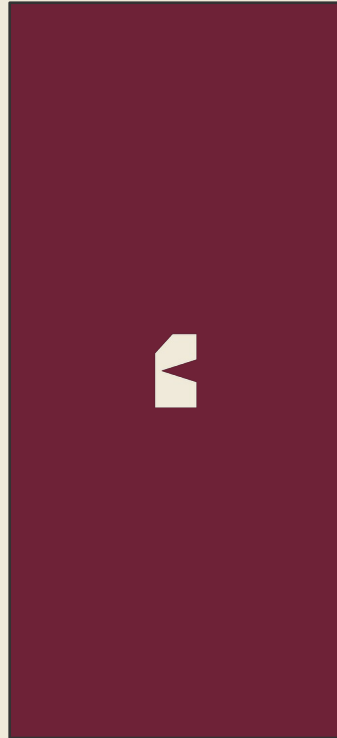
One colour only. Print black, Milk, Beetroot, White or Pickle. Never two colours, never outlined.

FILES 03_SYMBOL / NBA_Symbol_[Black|White|Ink|Primary|Milk|Pickle]_RGB.png · .svg · 3000 × 3000px, transparent.

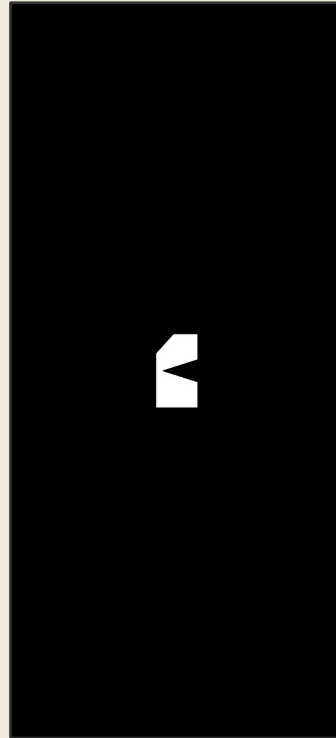
One colour, every surface



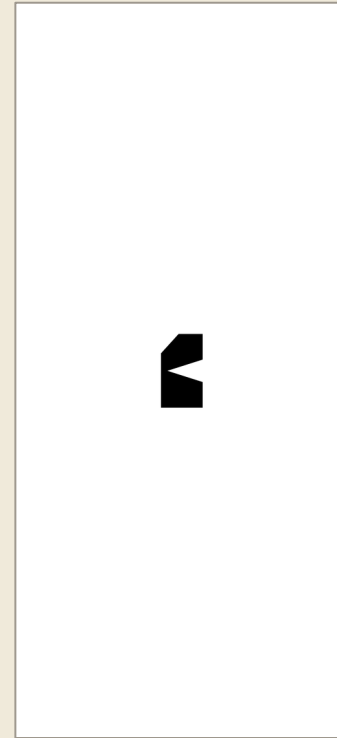
Print black



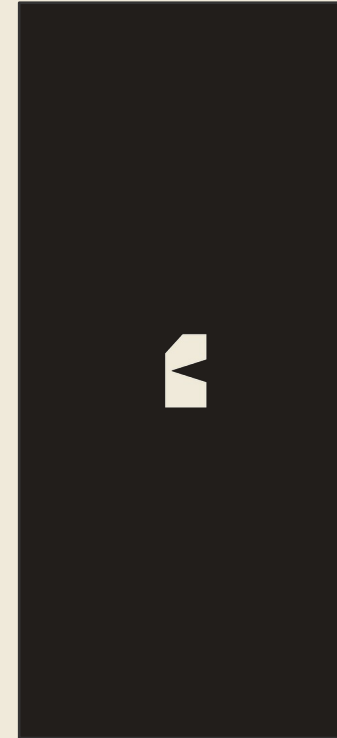
Milk on
Beetroot



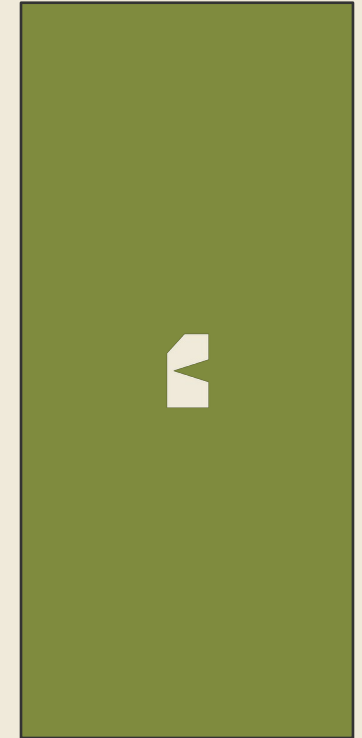
White on
black



Black on white



Milk on Print
black



Milk on Pickle

PRODUCTION Embroidery 14mm minimum, satin stitch, one thread. Deboss 10mm minimum, 0.4mm depth — the wedge becomes a shadow and improves. Stamp: one impression, off-register permitted. Screen print 12mm minimum. Screen: 16px minimum, no anti-alias correction needed.

Symbol and wordmark



Use

First introduction: website header, presentation covers, event identity, proposals, signage.

Spacing

The gap between symbol and wordmark is 0.62 of the symbol width. It never changes.

Alignment

Symbol baseline sits on the wordmark baseline. Symbol height is 1.30 cap heights.

Minimum

34mm wide in print. 180px on screen. Below that, use the wordmark or the symbol alone.

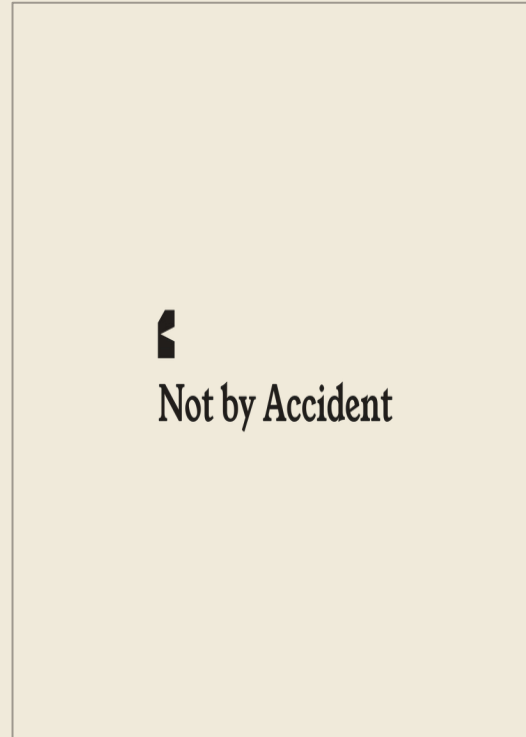
FILES 02_LOGOS / NBA_Logo_Primary_[Black|White|Ink|Primary|Milk|Pickle]_RGB.png · .svg · 4000px wide, transparent.

Four arrangements



Horizontal

The default.



Stacked

Narrow and vertical formats only.



Reversed

Dark and signature grounds.



On Beetroot

Milk artwork, never White.

There is no fifth lockup. Do not create one.

Standalone



Not by Accident

Use

Credits, footers, editorial, co-branding, documents, anything set at reading size.

Never rebuilt

Always supplied artwork. Do not set the name in the typeface and call it the wordmark.

Minimum

26mm wide in print. 140px on screen.

Colour

One colour. Print black, Milk, Beetroot or White.

FILES 04_WORDMARK / NBA_Wordmark_[Black|White|Ink|Primary]_RGB.png · .svg

Which mark, when

SYMBOL

Favicon · avatar · app icon · embroidery
· stamp · packaging · small physical
marks · film end card · signage on our
own building.

WORDMARK

Credits · footers · editorial · co-branding
· documents · invoices · contracts ·
press releases · anything at reading
size.

PRIMARY LOCKUP

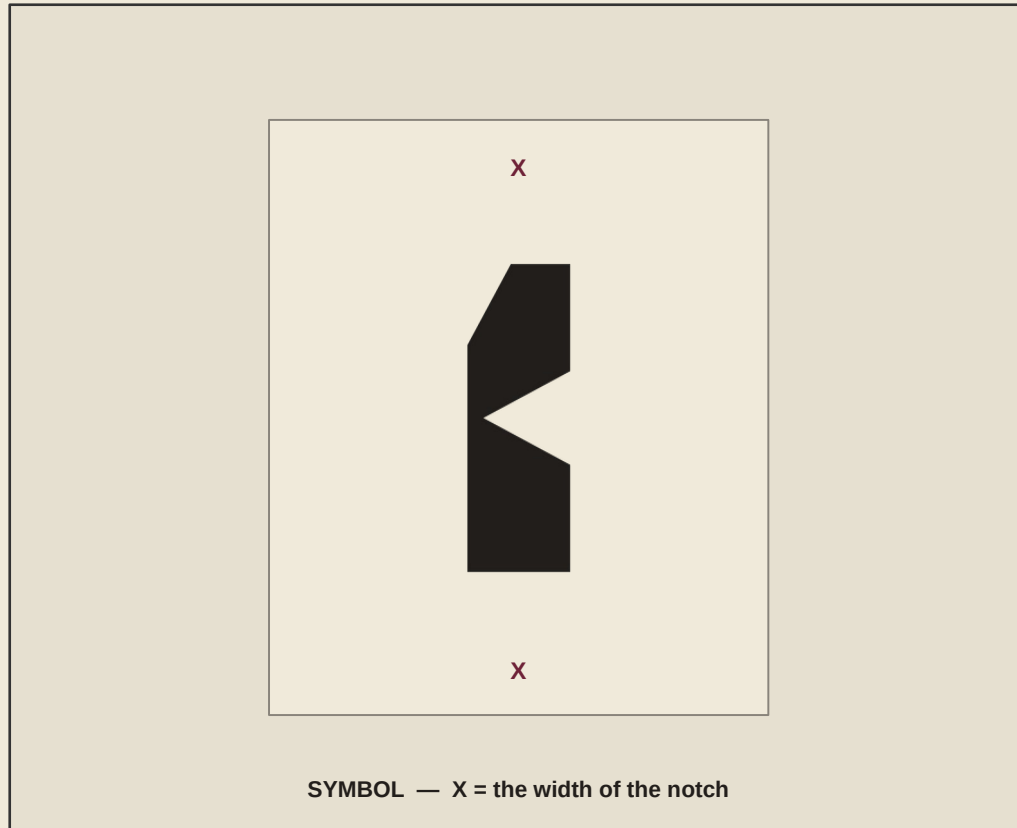
First brand introduction · presentation
covers · website header · event identity
· proposals · exterior signage.

STACKED LOCKUP

Narrow and vertical formats only:
spines, banners, tote panels, columns,
lanyards.

One logo per surface. The primary lockup and a standalone symbol never appear on the same page, screen or object.

Two units, four marks



Nothing enters the clear space — including page numbers, captions, rules and other logos. On photography the clear space is measured against the quiet area, not the frame edge.

MINIMUM SIZE

Tested, not theoretical

MARK	SCREEN	PRINT	EMBROIDERY	DEBOSS	SCREEN PRINT	BELOW MINIMUM
Symbol	16px	8mm	14mm	10mm	12mm	—
Wordmark	140px	26mm	—	22mm	24mm	Use the symbol
Primary lockup	180px	34mm	30mm	28mm	30mm	Use the wordmark
Stacked lockup	160px	30mm	26mm	26mm	28mm	Use the symbol

The wedge is the first thing to close. If it is not clearly open, the mark is too small for the process.

Approved, restricted, not approved



Milk **APPROVED**
Ink, Black or Beetroot artwork. 13.8:1.



Print black **APPROVED**
Milk or White artwork. 13.8:1.



Beetroot **APPROVED**
Milk or White artwork. 9.0:1.



Carbon violet **APPROVED**
Milk or White artwork. 4.7:1.



Pickle **RESTRICTED**
Milk artwork only, 30mm minimum. 3.1:1.



Yolk **RESTRICTED**
Print black or Black only. Never Milk.



White **APPROVED**
Black artwork. Production and third-party use.



Any tint or gradient **NOT APPROVED**
No tints, no gradients, no unapproved colour.

Contrast floor for any lockup is 4.5:1. Below that, use the symbol alone at increased size, or move the mark.

Placement

Find the quiet area

A flat region of a single value — wall, sky, table, fabric. The mark sits in the image, not on top of it.

Contrast

4.5:1 minimum against the area behind it, measured rather than judged. Milk on dark frames, Print black on light.

Scale

Never more than 14% of the image width. It is a signature, not a headline.

Complexity

If the image is busy everywhere, do not force it. Put the wordmark in the caption position beneath the frame.

Never

No scrim, no gradient, no drop shadow, no white box, no darkened corner, no outline. If the mark needs help, the placement is wrong.

On photography use the wordmark or the symbol alone. The primary lockup belongs on flat colour.

Never

Do not stretch or skew

Scale proportionally, always. No condensing, no extending, no perspective.

Do not rotate

The symbol has one orientation. The lockup is never set vertically — use the stacked version.

Do not outline or shadow

No strokes, no glows, no bevels, no gradients, no transparency below 100%.

Do not recolour

Only the approved one-colour versions. No tints, no brand-colour mixtures, no client colours.

Do not change spacing

The symbol-to-wordmark gap and the letter spacing are fixed. Do not re-space the name.

Do not alter geometry

The wedge, the chamfer and the proportions are fixed. Never redraw, never round, never simplify.

Do not contain it

No circles, no boxes, no badges, no plaques, no keylines around the mark.

Do not attach the tagline

"Wanted, on purpose." is a sentence, set separately. It is never locked to the logo.

Also: never use unapproved typefaces to set the name, never place the mark on low contrast, never use the Pride or mourning states decoratively.

Master, TM and ®

The logo consists of the words "Not by Accident" in a bold, serif font. There is no symbol to the left of the text.

Master

No symbol. The primary artwork for nearly all use: photography, environments, film, merchandise, editorial, internal.

The logo consists of the words "Not by Accident" in a bold, serif font, followed by a small trademark symbol (™) to the right of the word "Accident".

Unregistered

™ where an application is filed or intended but not granted. First use on a page, master thereafter.

The logo consists of the words "Not by Accident" in a bold, serif font, followed by a registered trademark symbol (®) to the right of the word "Accident".

Registered

® only in jurisdictions and classes where registration is granted. Never applied globally because it is true in one market.

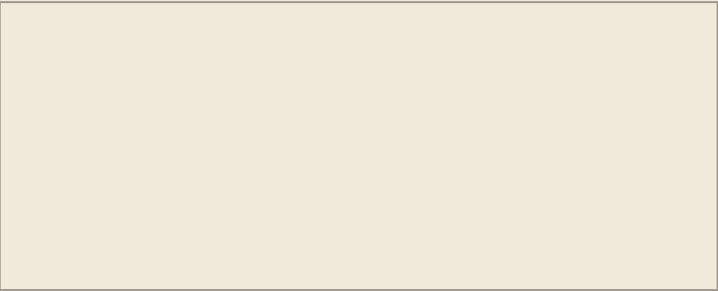
The symbol never carries TM or ®. Specification: 34% of cap height, aligned to cap top, 0.06em space. Confirm status with counsel before use.

04

Colour

Six colours. Three relationships that matter.

Foundation



MILK

HEX #F0EADA
RGB 240 · 234 · 218
CMYK 5 · 6 · 15 · 0
PMS 9224 C
LAB L 92.4 a 0.6 b 8.1
ROLE Primary ground

The ground of almost everything. Uncoated stock wherever possible; specify the paper rather than printing the colour.



PRINT BLACK

HEX #221E1B
RGB 34 · 30 · 27
CMYK 65 · 62 · 65 · 65
PMS Black 4 C
LAB L 12.2 a 1.3 b 2.2
ROLE Type and dark ground

Warm, never pure black. 300% build on uncoated. Never substitute #000 on screen.



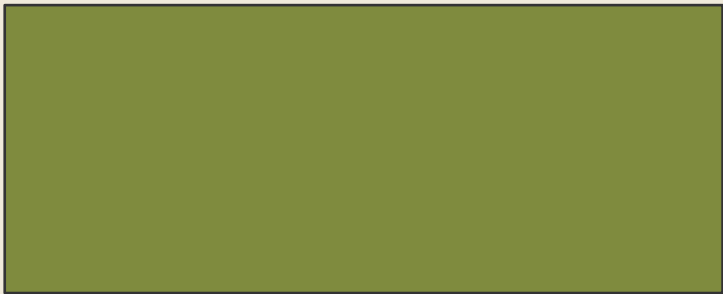
BEETROOT INK

HEX #6E2237
RGB 110 · 34 · 55
CMYK 34 · 92 · 64 · 38
PMS 505 C
LAB L 24.0 a 32.1 b 6.5
ROLE The anchor

The brand colour. Foil, cloth, edges, avatars, one field per surface. Double hit on uncoated or it goes brown.

Milk is the ground of the brand. Print black is warm, never pure. Beetroot is the brand colour and is used once per surface.

Signature and accent



PICKLE

HEX #7F8B3E
RGB 127 · 139 · 62
CMYK 55 · 34 · 90 · 15
PMS 5825 C
LAB L 55.4 a -14.6 b 39.2
ROLE The strange one

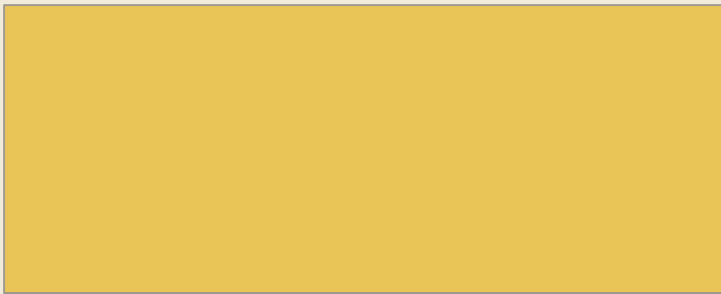
Small blocks, inside covers, one object in a photograph. Never a full field larger than A4.



CARBON VIOLET

HEX #6A6383
RGB 106 · 99 · 131
CMYK 64 · 62 · 27 · 8
PMS 667 C
LAB L 44.0 a 10.5 b -17.0
ROLE The quiet one

Long documents, research, secondary grounds. Uncoated only — it turns synthetic on gloss.



YOLK

HEX #E9C558
RGB 233 · 197 · 88
CMYK 9 · 22 · 74 · 0
PMS 7407 C
LAB L 81.3 a 3.6 b 55.6
ROLE The interruption

Rare. One appearance per project. Print black only on top of it; never Milk.

Pickle and Carbon violet are signature. Yolk is an accent used once per project. There is no seventh colour.

How much, how often

FOUNDATION — 82%

Milk, Print black, Beetroot. Present in almost everything. Milk carries the page; Print black carries the type; Beetroot appears once.

SIGNATURE — 7%

Pickle and Carbon violet. Small blocks, inside covers, edges, one object in a photograph. Never a field larger than A4 for Pickle.

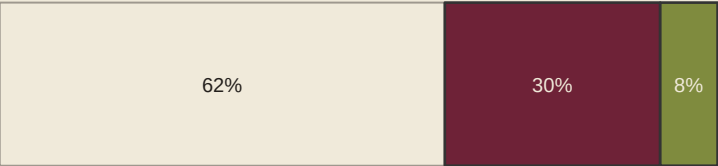
ACCENT — 1%

Yolk. One appearance per project. If it appears twice, it stops working.

Colour occupies roughly 10–25% of any surface. It lives at edges, inside covers, spines, small blocks and single objects — not as full-bleed fields. Two colours per surface; three only over eight pages, a space or a campaign.

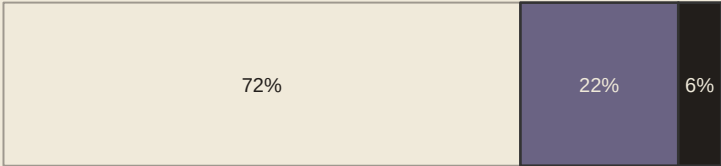
Six relationships

Proportions are binding. A relationship used at the wrong ratio is a different relationship and usually a worse one.



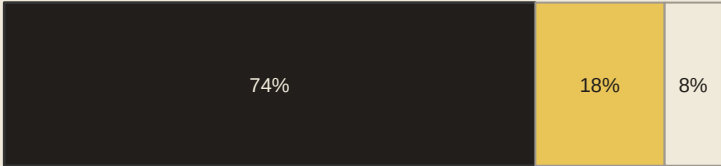
HOUSE

Milk ground, Beetroot field, Pickle at the edge. Covers, homepage, first contact. Type: Print black on Milk, Milk on Beetroot.



QUIET

Research, reports, long reading. Type: Print black throughout; Milk on Carbon at 16pt and above.



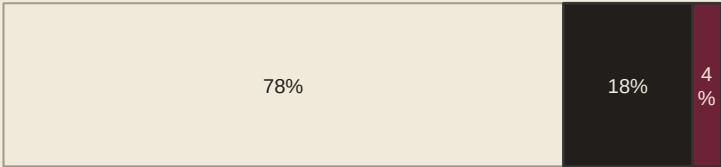
DARK

Events, film, dark interface, night. Type: Milk or Yolk on Print black. Logo: Milk or White.



ENERGY

Launches, posters, event walls. The loudest approved relationship. Type: Yolk on Beetroot, Print black on Yolk.



EDITORIAL

Publications, case studies, documents. Beetroot appears once per spread and only as a rule, an edge or a figure.



SPECIAL

Twice a year. Print and objects only, never screen. Type: Milk on both fields, 16pt minimum.

Not approved: Pickle with Yolk · Carbon with Beetroot · any two signature colours at equal weight · any colour with itself tinted.

One page, no paragraphs

COLOUR	ROLE	MAX	TEXT ON IT	LOGO ON IT	APPROVED BESIDE	NEVER BESIDE	D	P	S	PK	
	MILK	Primary ground	60%	Print black, Beetroot	Ink, Black, Beetroot	Everything	—	•	•	•	•
	PRINT BLACK	Type, dark ground	22%	Milk, Yolk	Milk, White	Milk, Yolk, Beetroot	Carbon	•	•	•	•
	BEETROOT INK	The anchor	10%	Milk, Yolk	Milk, White	Milk, Yolk, Pickle	Carbon	•	•	•	•
	PICKLE	The strange one	4%	Milk 18pt+, Print black 18pt+	Milk, White	Milk, Beetroot	Yolk	○	•	•	•
	CARBON VIOLET	The quiet one	3%	Milk 16pt+	Milk, White	Milk, Print black	Beetroot	○	•	○	○
	YOLK	The interruption	1%	Print black only	Ink, Black	Print black, Beetroot	Pickle	○	○	•	—

• primary ○ permitted – not used D digital · P print · S social · PK packaging

If a decision is not on this page, the answer is the House pair.

Behaviour off screen

Uncoated print	The default. Specify Milk as the stock rather than printing it. Beetroot needs a double hit. Pickle and Carbon are true. Yolk lifts slightly.
Coated print	Beetroot goes sweet — knock back 5% magenta. Carbon turns synthetic and should not be printed on gloss. Yolk is true.
Textile	Beetroot and Print black are excellent dyed and embroidered. Pickle is good in cotton, poor in synthetics. Milk on natural cotton reads as undyed.
Large-scale paint	Beetroot at 3m needs a matt finish or it reads plastic. Milk in emulsion reads warmer than on paper — specify one step cooler.
Screen	Never substitute #000 for Print black. Yolk fails against Milk at any size and is type-safe only on Print black.

Colour is proofed on stock before any hex is fixed on a printed job. Screen values are not a substitute for a proof.

05

Typography

A display serif, a plain grotesk, and one expressive face used almost never.

Seven roles

ROLE	TYPEFACE	SIZE	LINE HEIGHT	TRACKING	CASE	MAX LINE
DISPLAY	Display serif, Regular	56–120pt	0.98	–1.5%	Sentence	3 lines
HEADLINE	Display serif, Regular	32–48pt	1.05	–1.0%	Sentence	2 lines
SUBHEAD	Grotesk, Medium	18–22pt	1.25	0	Sentence	60 characters
BODY	Grotesk, Regular	15–17pt	1.55	0	Sentence	68 characters
CAPTION	Grotesk, Regular	10–12pt	1.4	+1%	Sentence	52 characters
UI	Grotesk, Medium	15–16px	1.4	0	Sentence	—
DATA	Grotesk, Regular, tabular	12–15pt	1.3	0	Lining	—
EXPRESSIVE	Expressive face	Any	—	—	Any	1 line, 5% of output

The wordmark typeface is used for the logo only. It never sets a headline, a paragraph or a caption.

Real content, not a specimen

We make companies wanted.

GROWTH IS WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

A brand is the reason a business costs less to run. Every soft attribute shows up one step downstream as a hard number: cost per acquisition, close rate, applications per role, price elasticity.

Photograph: Studio, March 2026

WEBSITE + EDITORIAL

We make companies wanted.

Growth is what happens next. A brand is the reason a business costs less to run.

See the work

MOBILE

Wanted, on purpose.

PRESENTATION

Nothing generic has ever been loved.

SOCIAL

Revenue

2024	£1,240,000
2025	£1,910,000
2026	£3,050,000

INTERFACE + DATA

Body is never below 15pt in print or 16px on screen. Line length is capped at 68 characters everywhere, including 16:9 slides.

The details

Marks

“Curly quotes” always · apostrophes ’ ·
em dash — parenthetical, spaced · en
dash – for ranges · hyphen for
compounds only · ampersand in names
only.

Numbers

Lining by default, tabular in tables and
data · 1,000 with a comma · 0.5 not .5 ·
ratios as 2:3 · 27% with no space.

Money and time

£48,000 — no space, no decimals
unless pence matter · 8 August 2026,
no ordinals · ranges 8–11 August · 24-
hour times in schedules only.

Links and notes

notbyaccident.com — lowercase, no
protocol, no trailing slash · email never
hyperlinked in print · footnotes
superscript numerals · bullets are en
dashes.

Tables: horizontal rules only, row banding at 6% Print black, figures right-aligned, no vertical rules, no coloured cells.

06

Image

Recognition comes from selection, not from a filter.

Three registers and six rules

HERO20% Produced. One idea, one location, one frame per project used large. Flash permitted, motion permitted, sharpness optional.	OBSERVATIONAL55% Real people, real work, real rooms. Available light, mid-gesture, faces welcome. This is most of what we publish.	INCIDENTAL25% Phone images, details, references, receipts, screens. Uncorrected, dated, credited. Never used in a client proposal.
LIGHTING One source. Available light by preference. Direct flash at night, indoors and close.	CROP Crop by the grid, not by the subject. A hand may be halved. Nothing is centred out of politeness.	COLOUR Shot warm, graded flat. One brand colour present as an object in frame, not as a filter.
PEOPLE Mid-conversation, working, walking, looking away, too close. Never lined against a wall.	RETOUCHING Colour and cleanup only. No skin work, no removals, no composites, no AI extension.	CREDITS Every photograph credited by name, on the page, every time — including phone images.

Yes and no

Yes

Specific: a named place, a real hour, a particular object.

Observational: somebody working, mid-conversation, looking away.

A strange detail that would normally be cropped out.

Real texture — paper, cloth, metal, food, skin.

A beautiful imperfect crop. A hand halved by the frame.

One brand colour present as an object, not as a grade.

Phone photographs, dated and credited.

No

Stock photography of any kind.

Laptops on desks. Meetings around a table. Handshakes.

Staged collaboration. Anyone pointing at a screen.

Over-retouched lifestyle. Skin work. Removed objects.

AI-generated or AI-extended people.

Team photographs lined up against a wall.

Anything with a filter, a preset or a house grade applied.

A premium brand knows which photographs need production and which need honesty. Roughly one image in five is produced.

07

Layout

Seven behaviours. Use one per surface.

Seven layout behaviours

The field

One object or image on a single colour, with generous margin. Use for covers, posts and packaging. Not for anything with more than twelve words.

The edge

Colour appears only as a band, spine or rule at one edge. Use for documents and stationery. Not where the surface must carry energy.

The interval

Two full surfaces in sequence, never both on screen. Use for scroll, carousels and film. Not in print.

The shelf

A horizontal band along the base or top carrying secondary information. The only behaviour permitted in interface.

Small against large

9pt caption beside 120pt display. Use for posters and openers. Not for dense information.

The dense page

Information at full density with no decoration. Use for research, data and reports. Colour stays in the margin.

The cluster

Three or four images at different sizes, unaligned to each other but aligned to the grid. Use for journal and social. Not for client work pages.

Rules for all seven

One behaviour per surface. Outer margins at 8% of the format. Nothing centred except a single line. Never two consecutive surfaces using the same behaviour.

08

Digital

Function first. The brand does not decorate the interface.

Grid, type, components

ITEM	SPECIFICATION
Grid	12 columns · 72px gutter desktop · 4 columns and 20px margin below 480px
Breakpoints	480 · 768 · 1024 · 1440 · 1920. Content capped at 1440px.
Spacing	8-point scale: 4 8 12 16 24 32 48 64 96 128
Responsive type	D1 clamp(40px, 6vw, 104px) · H1 clamp(26px, 2.6vw, 36px) · Body 16px fixed · measure 68ch
Buttons	44px minimum height · 2px radius · Beetroot fill, Milk label · hover 12% darker at 120ms
Inputs	1px border at 20% Print black · 2px radius · 44px minimum · helper text always present, never a placeholder
Links	Print black text with a 1px Beetroot underline at 0.12em offset · thickens to 2px on hover
Focus	2px Beetroot ring at 2px offset. Never removed for aesthetic reasons.
Selection	Yolk background, Print black text
Cursor	System default. On images only, a small crosshair. Nothing follows the mouse.
Icons	16 · 20 · 24px. 1.5px stroke. Never in a coloured circle.
Image ratios	3:2 landscape · 4:5 portrait · 1:1 objects. No other ratios.
Radius	0 by default. 2px on buttons and inputs. Full on avatars only.
Borders	1px, single value, no shadows on cards. One shadow token for sheets and menus only.

FILES 15_DIGITAL / tokens.css

Premium and accessible

Text contrast	Body copy AAA on Milk, Print black, Beetroot and Carbon. Print black on Milk is 13.8:1. Milk on Beetroot is 9.0:1.
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The two restrictions	Pickle carries text at 18pt and above only (3.1:1 with Milk). Yolk carries Print black only, never Milk. These are the only documented exceptions.
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Interface	Interactive elements and focus states meet 3:1 against adjacent colour. Touch targets 44 × 44px, 8px apart.
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Never colour alone	Errors carry an icon and a sentence. Links carry an underline. Charts carry direct labels, not a legend keyed by colour.
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Motion and keyboard	prefers-reduced-motion honoured everywhere. Full keyboard operation with a visible focus ring. Skip-to-content on every page.
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Automated checks in CI, plus one manual keyboard and screen-reader pass before any launch.

Four behaviours

Logo reveal

The symbol wipes in from the notch side over 500ms, then the wordmark. Once per session, film end cards and event screens. No second version.

Image transition

Cross-cut, never fade. 400ms. In a cluster, each image enters 80ms after the last so the group assembles.

Hover

Images lift 1.02 over 240ms with the frame fixed. Buttons darken 12% over 120ms. Nothing rotates, tilts or bounces.

Page transition

Push, not fade. 400ms. Screens behave like sheets of paper.

Timings 120 / 240 / 400 / 500ms. Easing cubic-bezier(.22,.8,.24,1). No parallax, no scroll-triggered showcase, no loading theatre, no sonic logo.

Homepage



HEADER

Lockup left, four words right. Nothing else above the fold.

HERO

One image or one Beetroot field. Never a colour block with a headline on it.

WORK

A list with numbers, not a grid of thumbnails.

COLOUR

Beetroot as image field, Pickle as a 16px rule. Milk carries the page.

TYPE

Display serif for the statement, grotesk for everything else.

HEADER, NAVIGATION, FOOTER, BUTTONS, CASE-STUDY CARD, ARTICLE, CONTACT, 404 all follow the same rules: one behaviour per screen, colour at 10–25%, the lockup only in the header.

09

Social

Families, not templates.

Eight families

FAMILY	COMPOSITION	TYPE	COLOUR	PHOTOGRAPHY	SYMBOL	WHAT IT IS
WORK	Field	Display serif	House pair	Hero	No	One frame. The caption carries the argument.
PEOPLE	Field, close crop	Caption only	Editorial	Observational	No	Named, always, in the caption.
POINT OF VIEW	Small against large	Display serif	Dark or Energy	None	Bottom right	A short argument, signed by a person.
REFERENCE	Interval	Caption only	From the image	Incidental	No	Credited to the source, every time.
RESULT	Shelf	One figure, large	Dark	None	Top left	One number, one line, one confidence label.
NOTES	Dense page	Body at reading size	Quiet	None	No	Longer thinking, set to be read.
ANNOUNCEMENT	Field	Display plus one line	Energy	Optional	Yes	One in twelve posts at most.
EVENT	Field	Display serif	Energy	Optional	Yes	Poster crop. Date and time in Yolk.

Carousel: statement on card one, symbol on the last card, nothing branded in between. **Reel cover:** one frame, one line, no logo. **Story:** looser than feed — phone footage, one line, one colour field.

Feed, profile and behaviour



PROFILE

Avatar: symbol only, Milk on Beetroot. Bio: two lines. Link: one.

RATIO

45% work and people · 30% notes and point of view · 15% reference · 10% results and announcements.

RULE

Never two posts from the same family in a row. Never two consecutive Beetroot fields.

SYMBOL

Appears on roughly one post in six. More than that and it becomes a watermark.

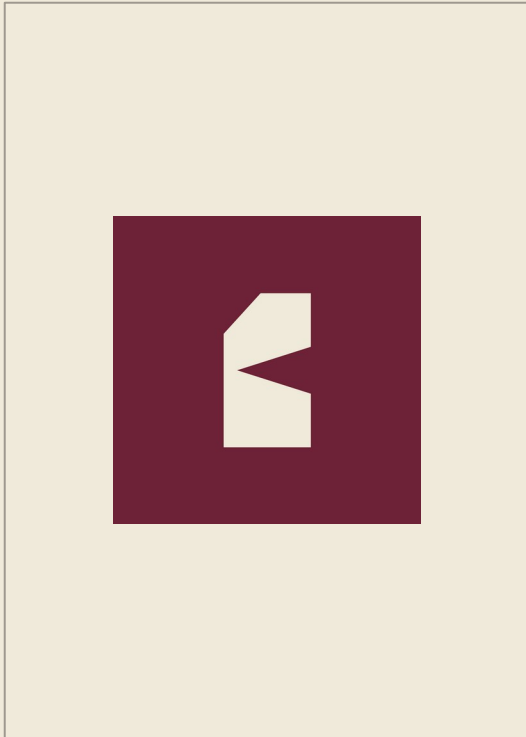
CAROUSEL

First card carries the statement, last card carries the symbol. Nothing in between is branded.

STORY

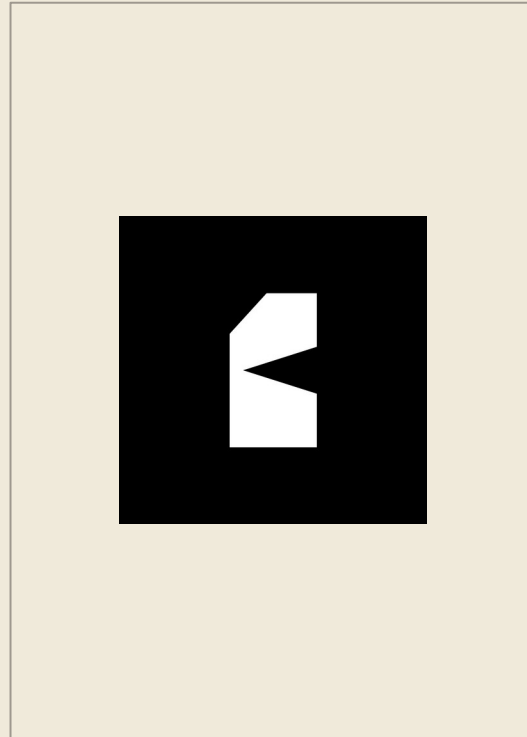
Looser than feed. Phone footage, one line of type, one colour field. Stories may be rough.

Official profile images



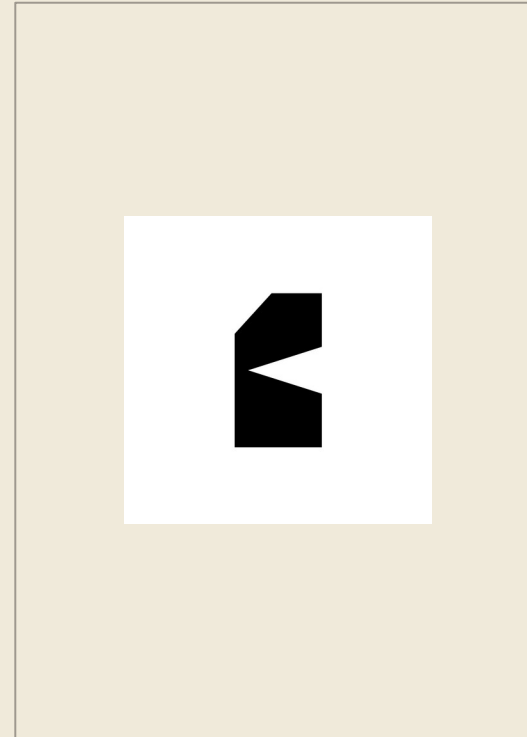
Default

Milk symbol on Beetroot. Used unless there is a reason.



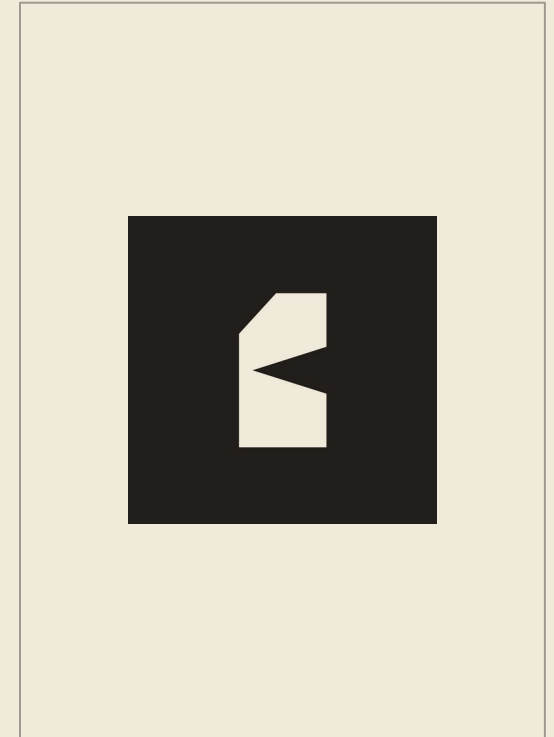
Black

For partners, directories and print.



White

For dark platform interfaces.

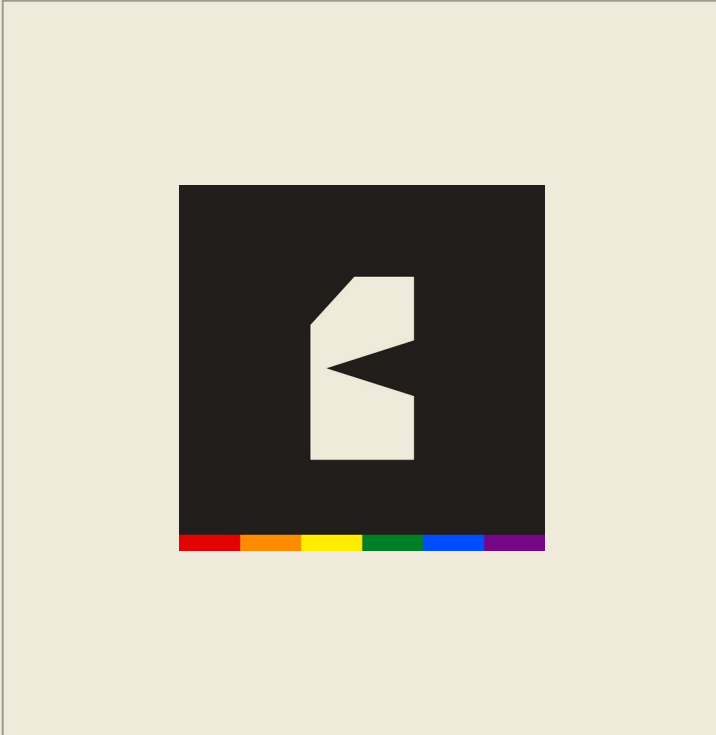


Ink

When the surrounding platform is light.

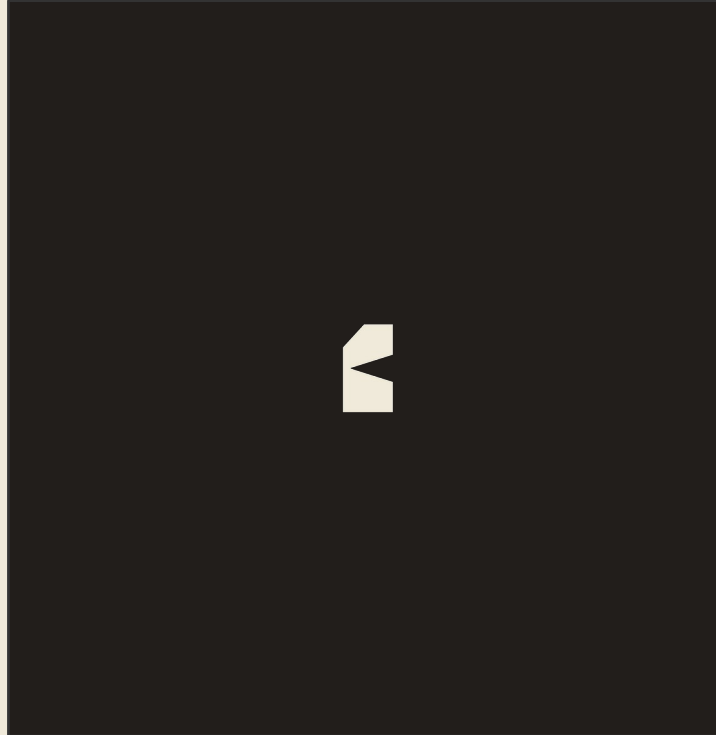
2000 × 2000px. The symbol sits at 50% of the frame so it works in a circle and a square at once. The avatar changes for a state, never for a campaign. **FILES 05_SOCIAL /**

The mark stays intact



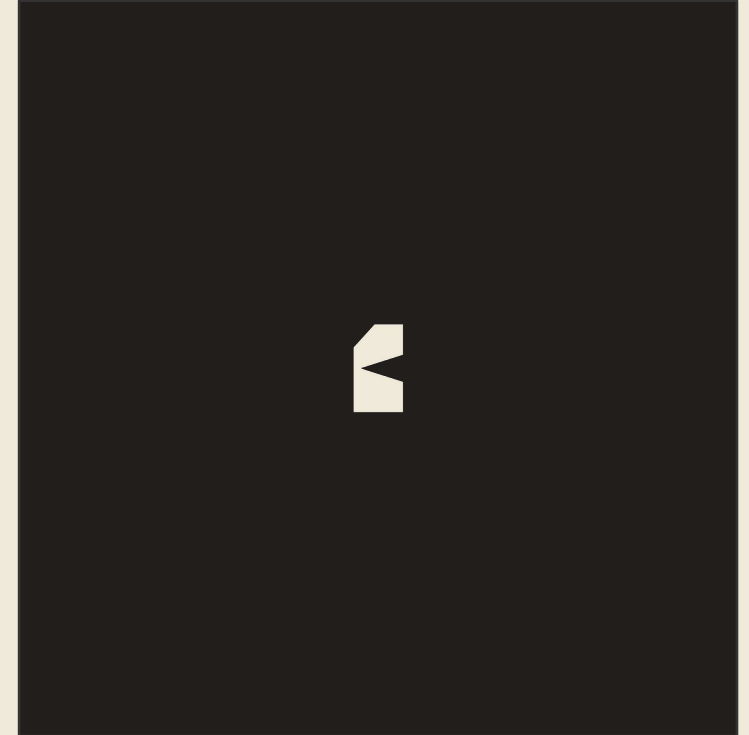
Pride avatar

Symbol unchanged. The spectrum appears as a band in the environment beneath it.



Feed treatment

Print black ground, Milk symbol, a 4% spectrum band at the base of the post. Type unchanged.



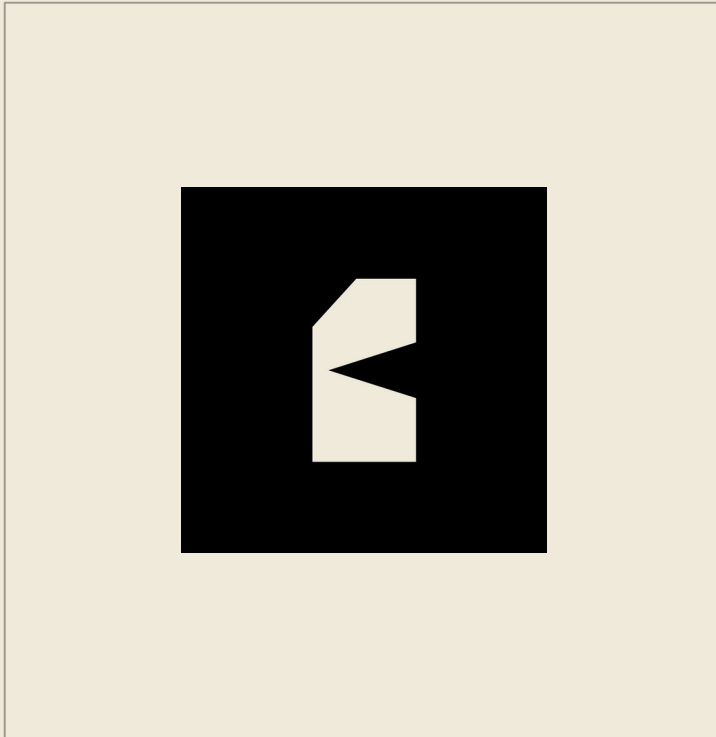
Story treatment

Same band, full width, at the base of the frame. One line of type. No slogan.

WHEN Pride month, and events we are genuinely part of, alongside one funded collaboration or one published piece of work a year. **NEVER** In advertising, on client work, on anything we sell, or in a market where we are doing nothing real. **HOW LONG** First of the month to the first of the next. Returns without a post.

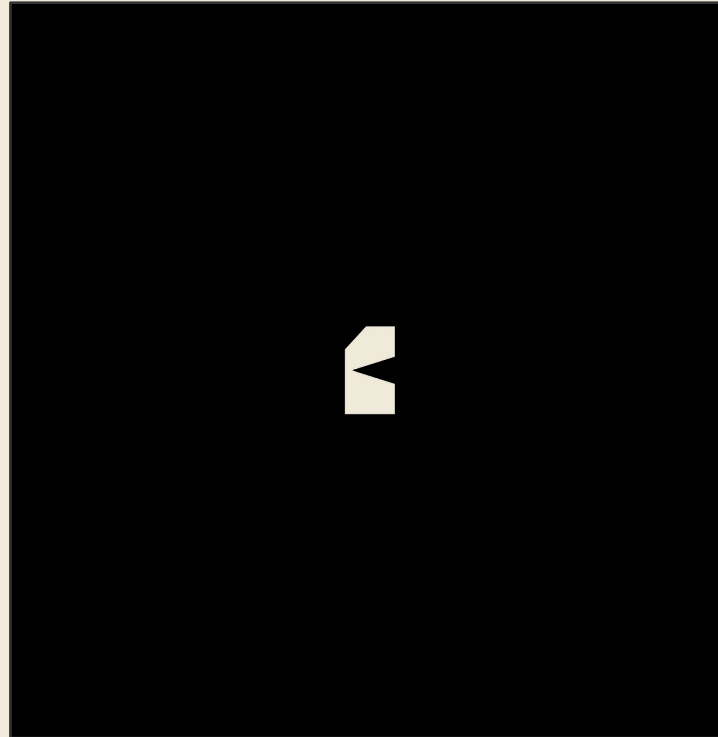
MOURNING

Black. Nothing else.



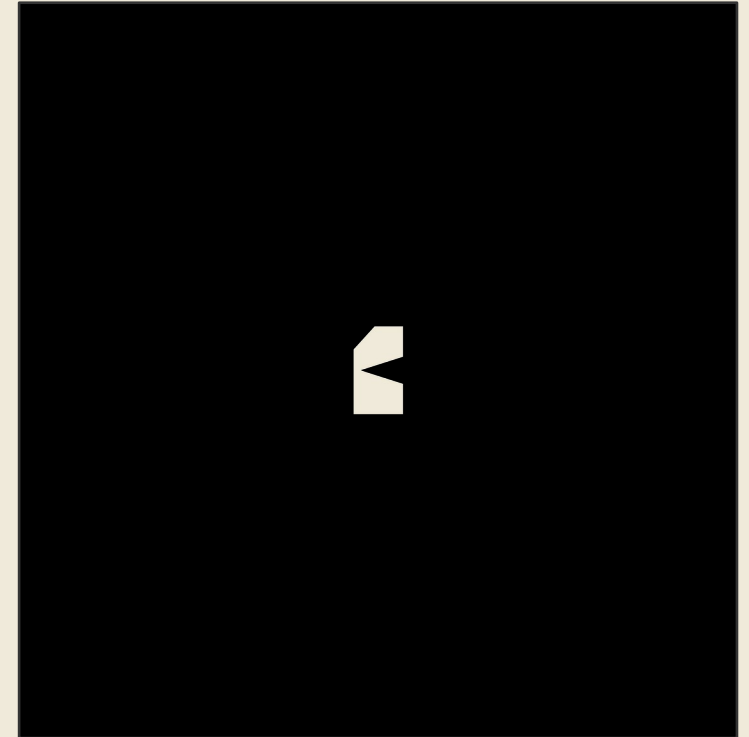
Mourning avatar

Black ground, Milk symbol. Geometry unchanged.



Post

Black. A name and a date at caption size, or nothing at all.

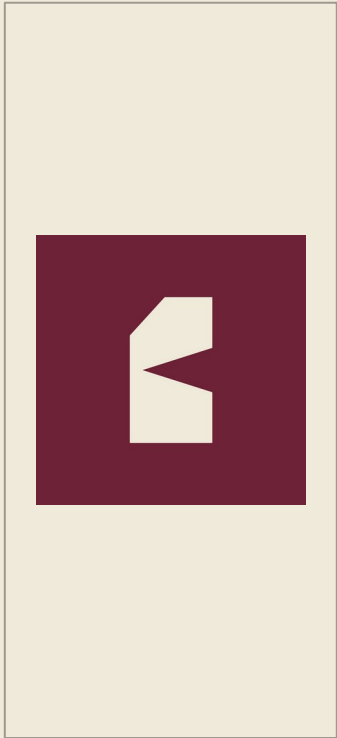


Story

Black. No type, no music, no link.

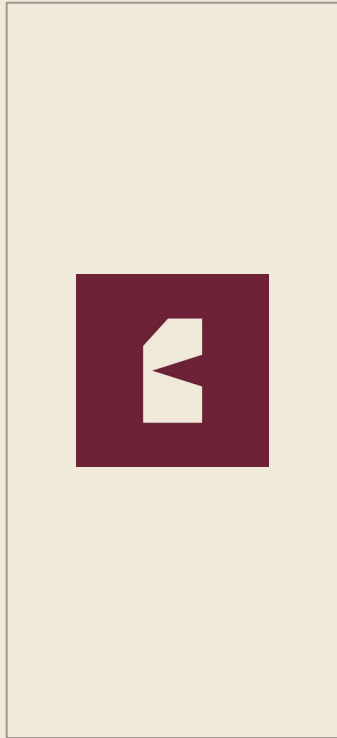
WHEN A death connected to the company or its work, or a tragedy where silence is the appropriate response. **HOW LONG** One to seven days, returning without announcement. **WHO** One named person, one conversation. No slogan, no marketing, no symbolic concept.

The symbol, every size



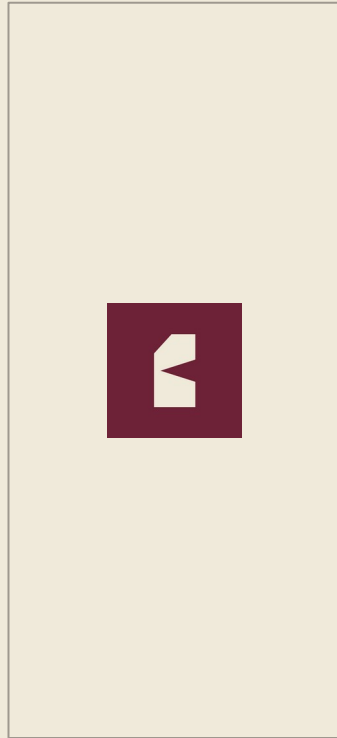
1024px

App store master



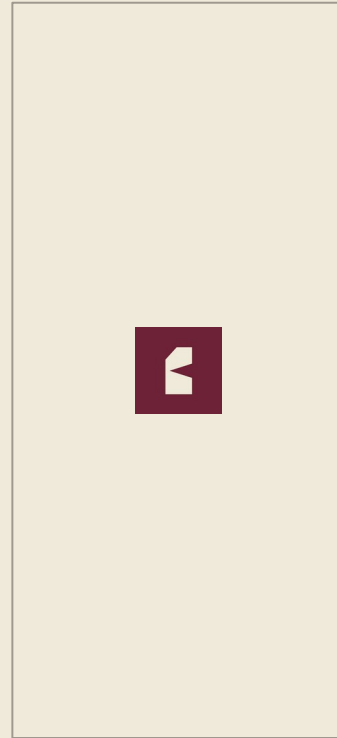
512px

PWA, Android



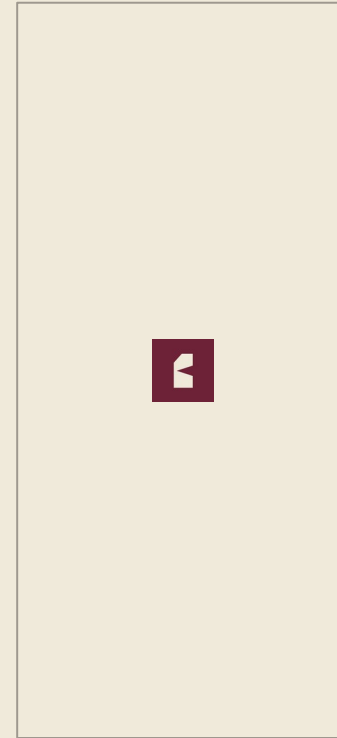
180px

Apple touch icon



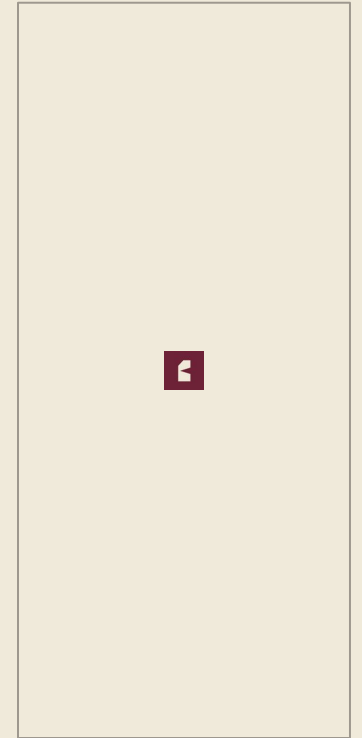
48px

Windows, legacy



32px

Retina tab



16px

Browser tab

FILES 08_FAVICONS / favicon.ico (16/32/48) and favicon-[16|32|48|180|512|1024].png. No coloured-rectangle fallback exists — the symbol clears 16px with the wedge open.

10

Print and objects

Premium through paper, touch, colour, construction and proportion.

Covers, headers, footers, data

A proposal for Lavanta

PROPOSAL

Where Lavanta stands

STRATEGY REPORT

What makes things wanted

RESEARCH

They were selling the second-best product

CASE STUDY

LETTERHEAD

INVOICE

- COVER

One field, one line, the symbol at 16mm top-left. Never the full lockup on an internal document.
- HEADER

Document name left, section right, both at caption size in the grotesk. Rule below at 0.5pt.
- FOOTER

Page number right. Nothing else. No logo, no strapline, no confidentiality paragraph.
- TABLES

Row banding at 6% Print black, horizontal rules only, tabular figures right-aligned.
- DATA

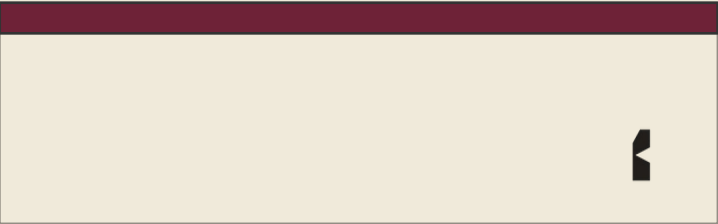
One figure per page in Beetroot. Everything else in Print black.

Five parts

The brief we were given	In the client’s words, quoted, short. It establishes what a reasonable company would have done.
The brief we took on	The reframe and the argument for it. The only place a reader watches us think.
What we decided	Three to five decisions, stated flatly, including the uncomfortable one. No process diagrams.
What we made	The work, large, almost uncaptioned, photographed existing in the world.
What happened	Brand, demand and business, each with a confidence label — then one line on what we would do differently.

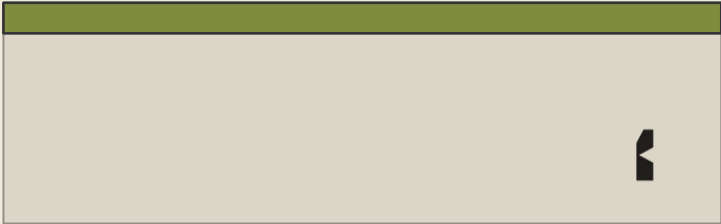
Layout: Editorial pair. Opening spread is one image and one line. The results page carries one Beetroot field and one figure. The final line is never edited out.

Six packages



DOCUMENT ENVELOPE

C4/C5 · 170gsm uncoated · Beetroot printed inside · gummed flap, one 32mm Milk seal, symbol debossed · Tier 1



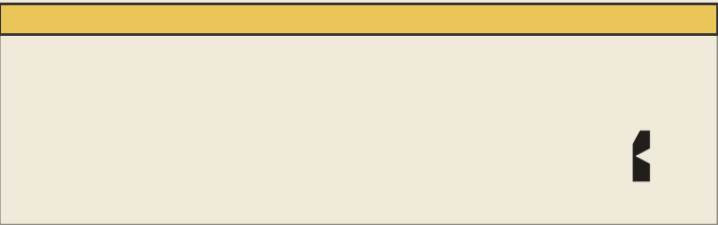
PROJECT BOX

2mm rigid board, dyed through · Pickle tray inside · symbol debossed 60mm, off-centre · no magnets, no foam · Tier 4



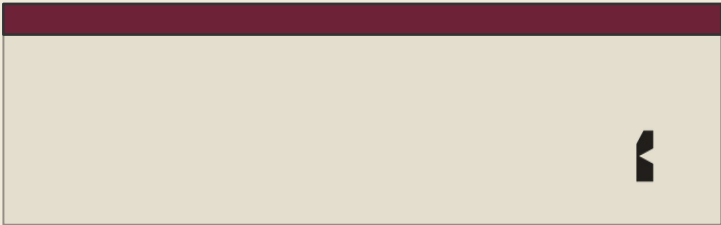
PUBLICATION WRAP

120gsm Carbon sheet folded round the edition · 25mm unbleached cotton tape · paper label, wordmark at 18mm · Tier 1



SMALL OBJECT

Kraft rigid sleeve · symbol screen-printed one colour · friction fit, no glue, no ribbon · Tier 2



SHIPPING

Plain recycled corrugate · one 90mm Beetroot label: symbol, address, nothing else · must cost the same as a plain box · Tier 1

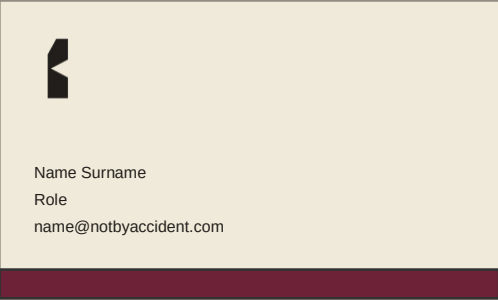


EVENT INVITATION

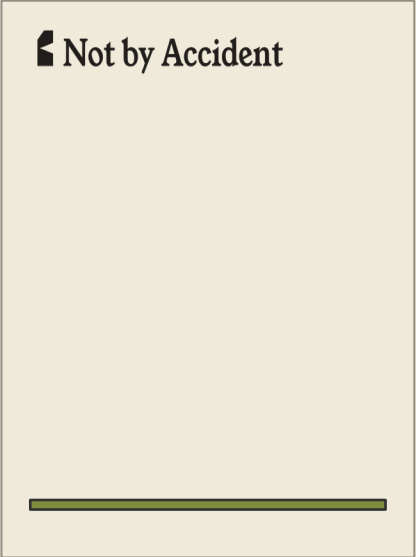
A6 · 350gsm · letterpress, Milk on Beetroot · Yolk edge paint · printed the week of the event · Tier 2

Permitted: uncoated stock, dyed-through board, book cloth, blind emboss, deboss, small-area foil, screen print, letterpress, cotton tape, paper seals. **Banned:** gloss laminate, magnetic closures, foam inserts, gold foil, spot UV, ribbon, tissue. **Rule:** packaging never costs more than what is inside it, and colour lives on the inside.

Thirteen items



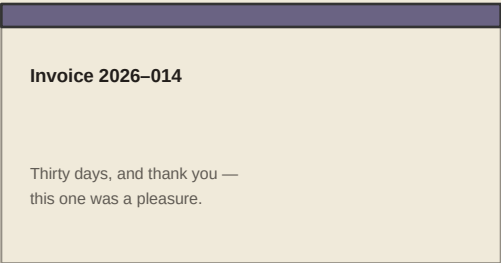
BUSINESS CARD 55 × 85mm · 600gsm duplex, Milk face / Beetroot core · letterpress



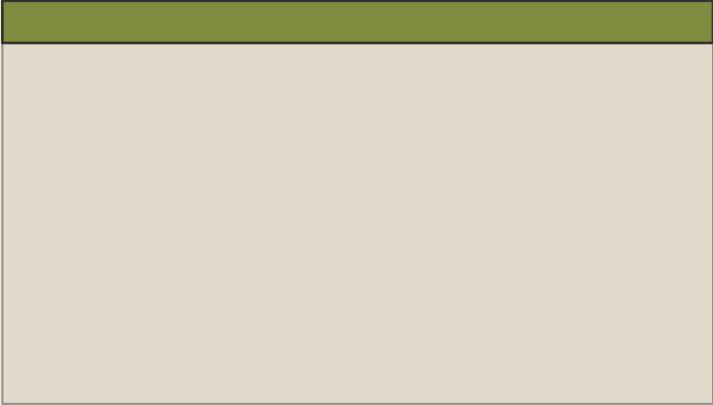
LETTERHEAD A4 · 120gsm uncoated · 2 colours



PROPOSAL COVER A4 · 350gsm · Beetroot, symbol debossed



INVOICE A4 · digital only



ENVELOPE C4/C5 · Milk outside, Pickle inside · no mark on the face

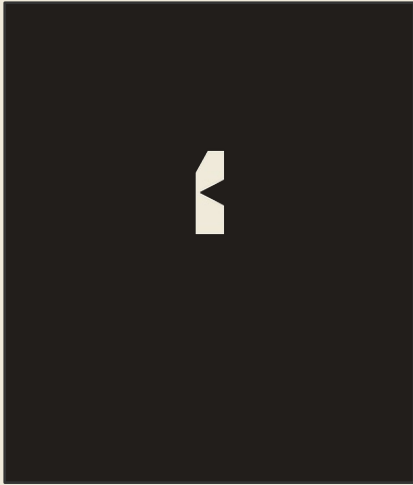


NOTEBOOK A5 · Print black cloth spine, Milk board, symbol debossed on the back

STICKER 45mm · symbol only, one colour

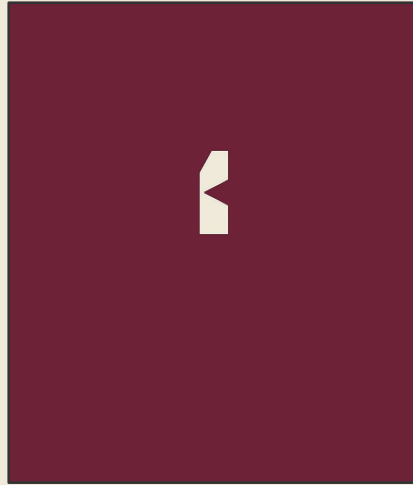
Also: compliments card A5 300gsm · folder wordmark on the spine only · packing slip with the name of whoever packed it · shipping label symbol and address only · name badge, name at 24pt and role at 12pt · lanyard, symbol at 16mm, Print black webbing.

Five objects



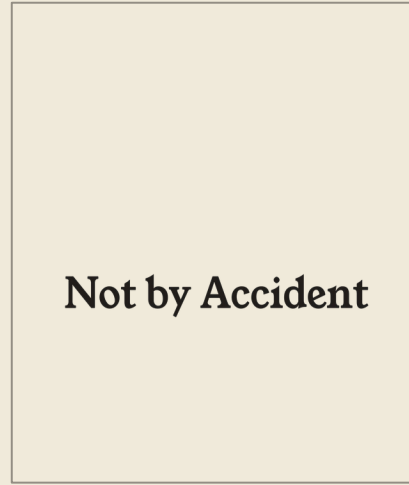
T-SHIRT

Symbol at 40mm, left chest, one colour.
Nothing on the back.



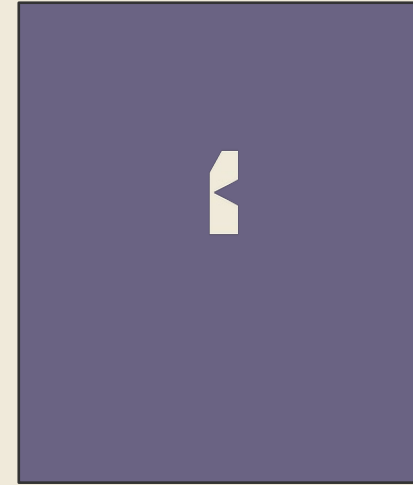
CAP

Embroidered symbol, 22mm, front
centre. No words.



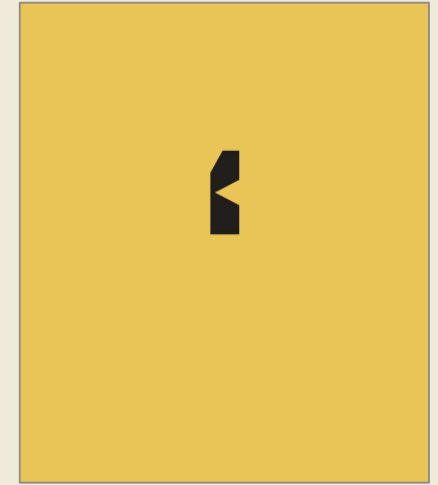
TOTE

Wordmark at 90mm, low on the bag,
Print black on natural cotton.



SWEATSHIRT

Symbol at 60mm, back of the neck.
Nothing on the chest.

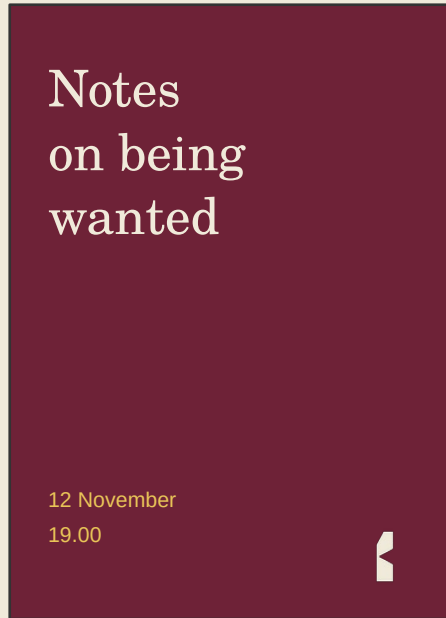


STICKER

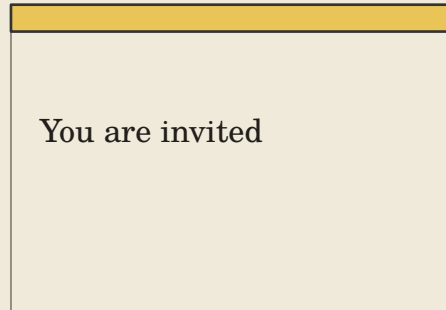
Symbol only, 45mm, die-cut to the mark.

The symbol alone is usually enough. Never put the full lockup on clothing. Nothing says "creative studio", nothing carries a strapline, and nothing is made that we would not own ourselves.

Poster to programme



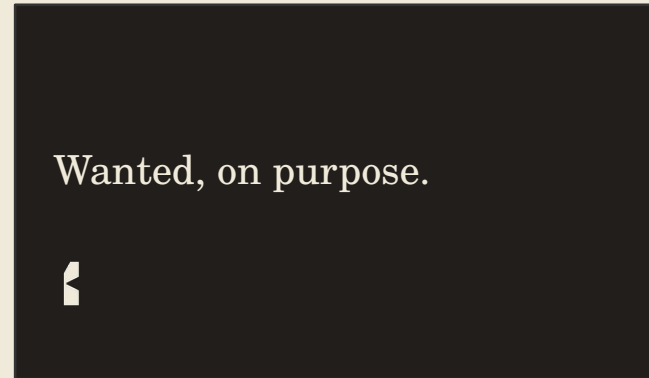
POSTER A1



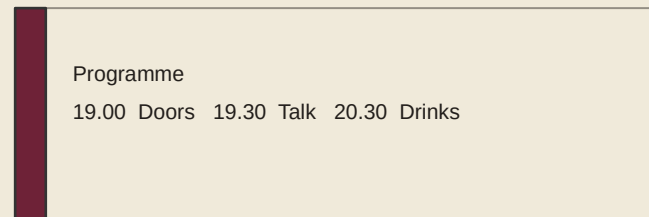
INVITATION A6, letterpress



LANYARD



STAGE SCREEN 16:9

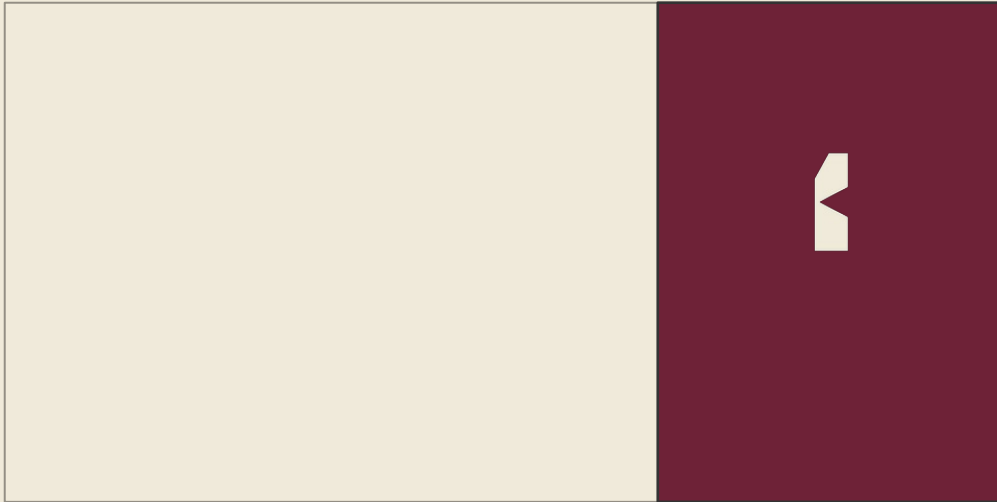


PROGRAMME A5

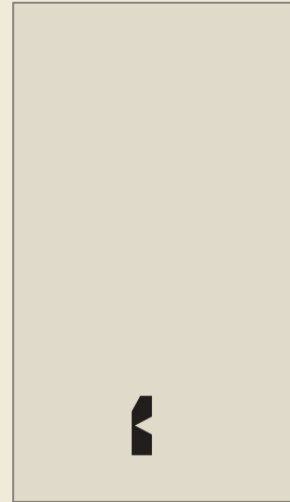


SIGNAGE 2400 × 1200mm

Walls, doors, windows



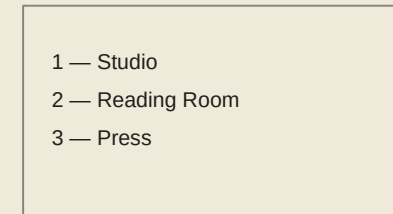
OFFICE WALL — one Beetroot field, symbol at 400mm, nothing else



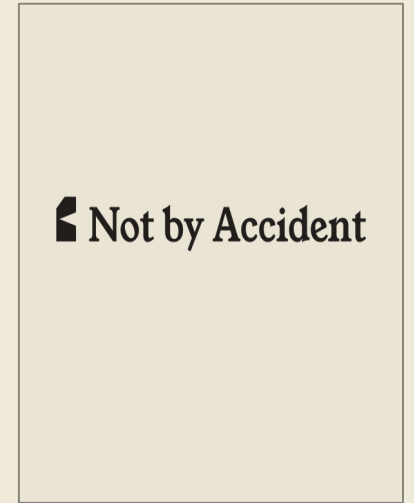
DOOR — symbol at eye height, debossed brass



MEETING ROOM PLAQUE



WAYFINDING — grotesk, numerals first



WINDOW VINYL — lockup at reading height, frosted, no colour



EVENT WALL — three metres of Beetroot, the symbol at 600mm, one line of Yolk type. Nothing else on the wall.

Techniques

TECHNIQUE	SUITS	SPECIFICATION	NOTES
Uncoated litho	Everything	300% max ink, Beetroot double hit	The default for all printed matter
Coated litho	Posters, packaging	Knock Beetroot back 5% magenta	Never print Carbon violet on gloss
Spot colour	Stationery, editions	PMS 505 · Black 4 · 5825 · 667 · 7407	Two spots plus stock is the house specification
CMYK	Documents, short run	Values as specified in the colour section	Proof on stock before approval
Screen print	Posters, textiles, boxes	Symbol 12mm minimum, one colour	Off-register by up to 0.5mm is acceptable
Embroidery	Caps, sweatshirts	Symbol 14mm minimum, satin stitch	One thread colour only
Foil	Covers, spines	Beetroot or Print black, 40mm maximum	Never gold, never across a full cover
Deboss	Cards, notebooks, boxes	10mm minimum, 0.4mm depth	The house finish. Cheapest way to look expensive.
Letterpress	Cards, invitations	600gsm minimum, single hit	Bite is visible and welcome

Not used: spot UV, gloss lamination, thermography, holographic, textured varnish.

11

Operations

Presentations, partners, credits, files.

Twenty-one masters

SLIDE	GROUND	BEHAVIOUR	TYPE
Cover	Beetroot or image	Field	Display, one line
Section divider	Print black	Field	Numeral and title
Single statement	Milk	Small against large	Display, three lines maximum
Two-column	Milk	Shelf	Subhead and body
Three-column	Milk	Shelf	Subhead and body
Text and image	Milk	Field	Body, caption
Image hero	Image	Field	Caption in the margin
Comparison	Milk	Shelf	Subhead, one rule, no colour coding
Timeline	Milk	Shelf	Five nodes maximum
Process	Milk	Shelf	Four steps, display numerals
Case study	Milk	Dense page	The five parts, one per slide
Quote	Carbon	Field	Display, attributed by name
KPI	Print black	Shelf	Three figures maximum. Yolk on one
Chart	Milk	Dense page	Direct labels, two series
Table	Milk	Dense page	Row banding, horizontal rules only
Research findings	Milk	Dense page	Body, footnotes
Team	Milk	Cluster	Named photographs
Client logos	Milk	Shelf	Matched cap height, four rows maximum
Project gallery	Milk	Cluster	Three across
Closing	Beetroot	Field	Statement and contact
Contact	Milk	Edge	One name, one email

FILE 11_PRESENTATION / NOT BY ACCIDENT — PRESENTATION TEMPLATE.pptx — built on three masters: NBA_LIGHT, NBA_DARK, NBA_COLOUR.

Charts

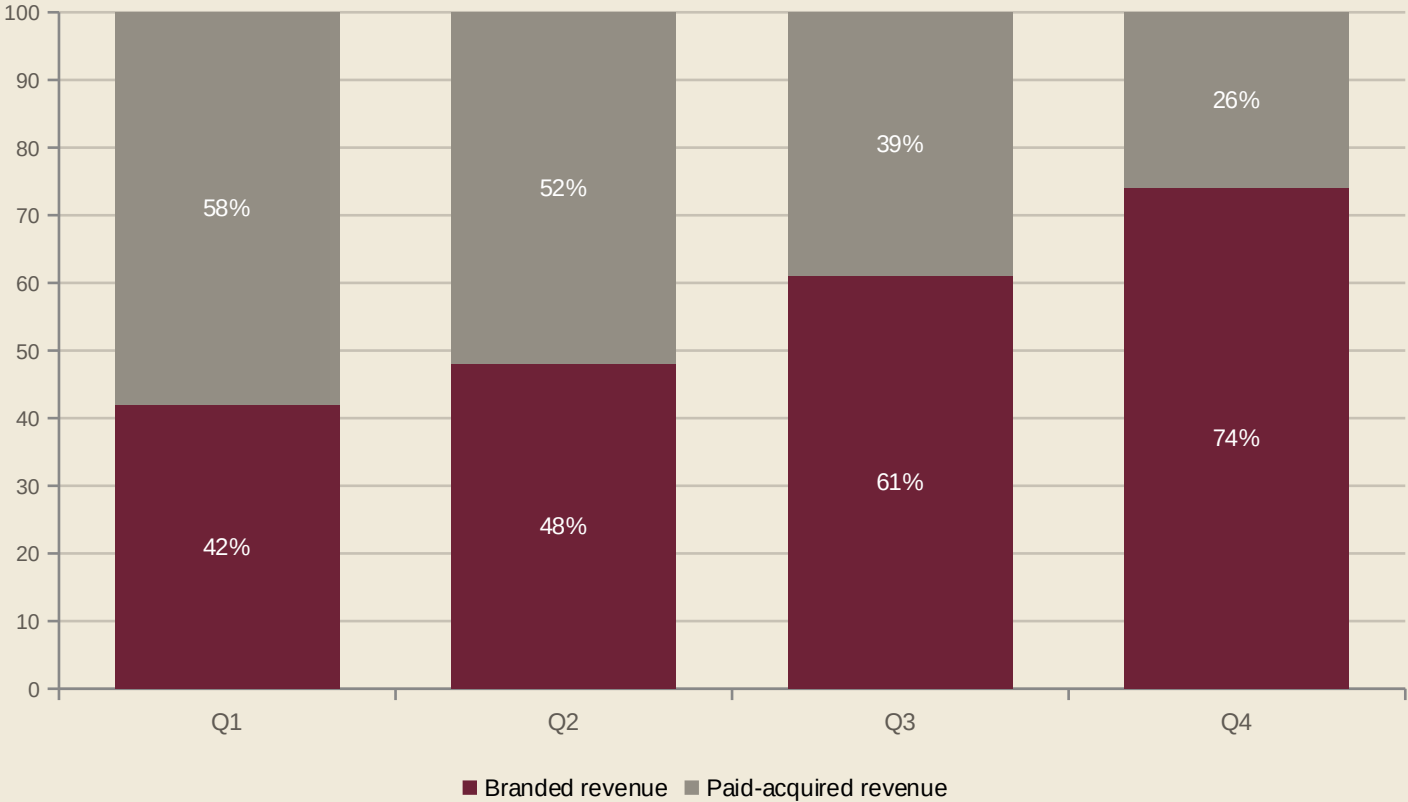


Chart rules

One chart per slide. Two series maximum, in Beetroot and a 45% Print black. Direct labels rather than a legend where the chart allows it. Gridlines at 20% Print black, 1px. No 3D, no shadows, no gradients, no doughnuts. Exactly one figure per slide may be set in Yolk — the one being argued about.

Line charts follow the same rules: two series, 2px stroke, no markers except at the final point.

Tables, roadmaps and footnotes

ENGAGEMENT	TEAM	WEEKS	FEE	STATUS	MARGIN
Lavanta — Launch	5	22	£188,000	Delivered	41%
Studio Marché — Reset	3	11	£96,000	Delivered	46%
Edde — Scale	4	16	£142,000	In progress	38%
Unnamed — Companion	2	52	£240,000	Signed	52%
Cultural collaboration	2	6	£18,000	Delivered	9%
Research edition 01	1	8	£12,400	Delivered	—
Total	—	—	£696,400	—	40%

¹ Margin is contribution after direct cost, before overhead. ² The cultural collaboration is priced at cost by policy. Footnotes are superscript numerals at caption size, at the foot of the slide, and are present on any slide carrying a figure.

Compatibility

Fonts	The display serif and the grotesk are not available in Google Slides. Fallbacks: a transitional serif for display, a neutral grotesk for everything else. Set the fallback once in the theme, never per slide.
Do not use	Gradient fills, shape effects, custom bullets, embedded charts with custom axes, text-box shadows, grouped master objects. All of them break on import.
Do use	Solid fills, straight rules built as rectangles, plain text boxes, images placed rather than cropped in software, tables built as tables.
Colour	Set the six brand colours as theme colours on first import. Google converts hex accurately; it does not carry Pantone.

A deck built to these rules survives PowerPoint, Google Slides and Keynote without redesign. Anything more elaborate is rebuilt as a PDF.

Beside somebody else

Equal partnership

Both wordmarks at matched cap height, separated by a 1px Print black rule at twice cap height. Alphabetical order. Our symbol does not appear.

Not by Accident led

Our primary lockup, the rule, then the partner wordmark at 85% cap height. Only when we are the commissioning party.

Client led

The client's mark alone at full size. Our presence is a credit line, not a logo. This is the default for all client work.

Sponsored event

Wordmark only, at 70% of the host's mark, in the lowest position on the surface. Never the symbol on somebody else's event.

The loudness rule

The symbol is never used in a co-branded lockup. It is our face, not our signature.

Partner marks are never recoloured to our palette, never placed on Beetroot, and never scaled below their own stated minimum.

How the work is signed

Approved

PRIMARY — "Identity by Not by Accident". Four words, caption size, in the grotesk.

EXTENDED — "Brand, product and launch by Not by Accident" where the scope warrants naming it.

COLLABORATION — "[Partner] with Not by Accident". Their name first, always.

FILM AND EVENTS — the wordmark alone on the final frame, two seconds maximum.

PLACEMENT — site footer, back of packaging, last page of a document, end of a case study.

Not used

"Designed by" — understates the work. We are rarely only designing.

"Made with" — vague, and it implies a tool.

"Not by Accident for [Client]" — puts us first on their property.

"Powered by" — technology language for a company that is not a platform.

"A Not by Accident company" — untrue, and it sounds like a holding group.

The symbol used as a credit. A mark on somebody else's work is a claim; a line of type is a fact.

The credit is agreed at contract signature, not requested at launch.

Four lines, plain text

Format

Name Surname / Role / Not by Accident / notbyaccident.com. Four lines, left aligned, no indent.

Type

System sans at 13px, single colour. Name in medium, everything else regular. Print black at 100% and 60%.

Never

No image, no logo file, no social icons, no strapline, no confidentiality paragraph, no "sent from" line, no quotation.

Phone

Only for people who want to be called. Optional, never mandatory, always the last line.

The signature is text so that it survives forwarding, plain-text clients and mobile. An image signature is not approved under any circumstance.

One convention

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	NOTES
NBA_[Asset]_[Variant]_[Colour]_[Mode].[ext]	NBA_Logo_Primary_Black_RGB.svg	Underscores only. No spaces, no dates, no version numbers in the filename.
Asset	Logo · Symbol · Wordmark · Social · Favicon	One word, capitalised.
Variant	Primary · Stacked · Default · Pride · Mourning	Omitted where there is only one.
Colour	Black · White · Ink · Primary · Milk · Pickle	Always stated, even for one-colour masters.
Mode	RGB · CMYK · 1C	1C for single-colour production artwork.
Extension	svg · pdf · png · ico	No JPEG logos, ever.

Version control lives in the folder, not the filename. Superseded artwork is deleted, not renamed.

Folder structure

FILE	FORMAT	USE
/01_GUIDELINES	PDF · PPTX	Complete guidelines, quick guide, asset index
/02_LOGOS	PNG · SVG	Primary horizontal and stacked, all colourways, ™ and ® versions
/03_SYMBOL	PNG · SVG	The Nick, all colourways, 3000 × 3000px
/04_WORDMARK	PNG · SVG	Standalone wordmark, all colourways
/05_SOCIAL	PNG	Avatars 2000 × 2000px
/06_PIDE	PNG	Pride avatar and lockup
/07_MOURNING	PNG	Mourning avatar and lockup
/08_FAVICONS	PNG · ICO	16 to 1024px and favicon.ico
/09_COLOUR	CSV	Full colour specification
/10 TYPOGRAPHY	MD	Type specification and licensing
/11_PRESENTATION	PPTX	Presentation template with masters
/12_DOCUMENTS	MD	Document and case-study specification
/13_PACKAGING	MD	Packaging specification by type
/14_STATIONERY	MD	Stationery specification
/15_DIGITAL	CSS	Design tokens
/16_SOCIAL_TEMPLATES	MD	Social family specification
/17_PRINT_SPECS	MD	Stocks, inks, finishes
/18_ASSET_INDEX	PDF	This index

Every master logo is delivered as PNG, SVG and PDF vector. SVG and PDF are outlined — no font dependency. PNG is transparent. There are no JPEG logos.

What must be bought

ROLE	ORIGIN	LICENCE REQUIRED	FALLBACK
Wordmark	Open licence (SIL OFL)	None. Embedding and modification permitted.	Not applicable — the wordmark is supplied as outlined artwork
Display serif	Open licence (SIL OFL)	None for desktop, web or app	Georgia
Grotesk	Open licence (SIL OFL)	None for desktop, web or app	Arial / Helvetica
Expressive	Open licence (SIL OFL)	None	Omit rather than substitute
Licensed upgrade	Independent foundry	Desktop, web by domain and pageview band, app by title	Priced separately, not a launch dependency

Font files are never distributed with this kit or with client hand-offs. Each party licenses its own. The logo artwork carries no font dependency.

Nine questions

☐	Logo	Correct mark for the surface, from supplied artwork, never rebuilt.	☐	Clear space	X around the symbol, Y around the lockup. Nothing inside it.
☐	Colour pair	One of the six approved relationships, at the stated proportion.	☐	Colour amount	Between 10% and 25% of the surface. Never a full-bleed field with a headline on it.
☐	Type	Correct role, correct size, measure under 68 characters.	☐	Micro type	Curly quotes, en dashes, tabular figures, no straight apostrophes.
☐	Photography	Correct register, credited, no filter, no stock.	☐	Contrast	4.5:1 for text, 3:1 for interface. Pickle and Yolk restricted.
☐	File	Correct colour mode, correct format, correct name.	☐	Special states	Pride and mourning used only within their governance.

If all ten are yes — publish.



Wanted, on purpose.

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